

THREAT ADVISORY



ACTOR REPORT

Chinese APT Earth Preta runs spearphishing campaigns

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Admiralty code

A1

TA Number

TA2022266

Summary

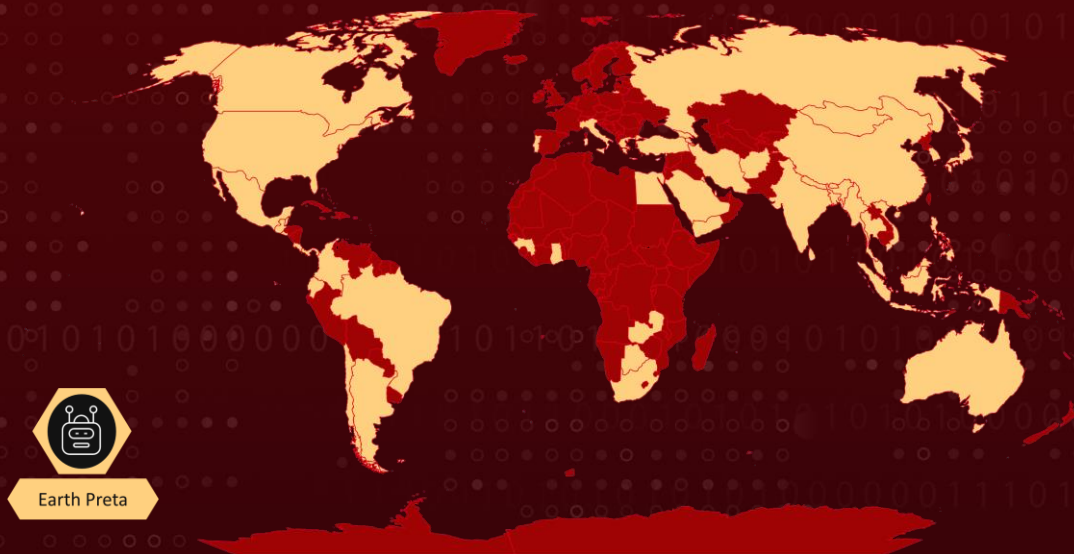
First Appearance: 2014

Actor Name: Earth Preta

Target Countries: Australia, Bangladesh, Belgium, China, Cyprus, Ethiopia, Germany, Greece, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, Mongolia, Myanmar, Nepal, Pakistan, Philippines, Russia, Singapore, South Africa, South Korea, South Sudan, Taiwan, UK, USA, Vietnam

Target Sectors: Aviation, Education, Government, NGOs, Think Tanks, Telecommunications

Actor Map



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Actor Details

#1

Earth Preta, an APT gang, staged a large-scale cyber espionage campaign in which the malware was transmitted via spear-phishing emails. The actors use various strategies to avoid detection and analysis, such as code obfuscation and custom exception handlers.

#2

Deceptive files covering sensitive geopolitical issues are used to persuade the target into downloading and stealthily loading the malware in the background using a technique known as DLL side-loading. The malware families TONEINS, TONESHELL, and PUBLOAD are included in the archives.

#3

The actors have a history of creating their custom loaders and utilizing them with already-existing tools like PlugX and Cobalt Strike. The sensitive documents obtained by the gang after they have gained access to a victim's systems could be utilized as entry points for subsequent attacks.



Actor Group

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET COUNTRIES	TARGET INDUSTRIES
Earth Preta (Mustang Panda, Bronze President, TEMP.Hex, HoneyMyte, Red Liche)	China	United States, Canada, Mexico, Guatemala, Belize, El Salvador, Costa Rica, Panama, Colombia, Ecuador, Brazil, Argentina, Chile, Falkland Islands, Guinea, Ghana, Zambia, Botswana, South Africa, Egypt, Saudi Arabia, Yemen, Kuwait, Qatar, Bahrain, Iran, Afghanistan, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Georgia, Turkey, Cyprus, Greece, India, Sri Lanka, Australia, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, Myanmar, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Nepal, China, Vietnam, Philippines, South Korea, Japan, Russia, Mongolia, Portugal, Italy, United Kingdom, Ireland, Finland, Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania, Poland, Belarus, Ukraine, Romania, Hungary, Bulgaria, North Macedonia, Albania, Croatia, Germany, Austria, Czechia, Belgium, Denmark, Malta	Aviation, Education, Government, NGOs, Think Tanks, Telecommunications
	MOTIVE		
	Information theft and espionage		



Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actor through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5’s Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the ‘Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs’ & ‘Indicators of Compromise (IoC)’ on the following pages.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence
<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>T1547</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	<u>T1547.001</u> Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder
<u>T1574</u> Hijack Execution Flow	<u>T1574.002</u> DLL Side-Loading	<u>T1053</u> Scheduled Task/Job	<u>T1053.005</u> Scheduled Task
<u>T1140</u> Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information	<u>T1036</u> Masquerading	<u>T1036.005</u> Match Legitimate Name or Location	<u>T1071</u> Application Layer Protocol
<u>T1071.001</u> Web Protocols	<u>T1095</u> Non-Application Layer Protocol	<u>T1573</u> Encrypted Channel	<u>T1573.001</u> Symmetric Cryptography
<u>T1104</u> Multi-Stage Channels	<u>T1587</u> Develop Capabilities	<u>T1587.001</u> Malware	<u>T1566</u> Phishing
<u>T1566.002</u> Spearphishing Link	<u>T1583</u> Acquire Infrastructure	<u>T1583.004</u> Server	<u>T1585</u> Establish Accounts

<u>T1585.002</u> Email Accounts	<u>T1588</u> Obtain Capabilities	<u>T1588.002</u> Tool	<u>T1608</u> Stage Capabilities
<u>T1608.001</u> Upload Malware	<u>T1204</u> User Execution	<u>T1204.001</u> Malicious Link	<u>T1204.002</u> Malicious File

✂ Indicator of Compromise (IOC)

TYPE	VALUE
URLs	https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1pJR6hvEcdZFNPS9Bluw2Egcp_gb-pvLR&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1t0Cxanp-cm9bOyOfrfu5BN1ya2CZs-3q&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=12ZEERd58S25zxAWUF5tiBSPOs wYgtU2j&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1OGNqBZNG57STWtoTIUwoBMFDlcu9AMh1&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1BG0F1NdkpZYOY6w2Y0YEs6nMGYLvSjiQo&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1mQGqtxR8XzafPaID7hEUBZw-LHtPHeAG&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1mhv6sOKU1OmqrX3PRB7fme-STM8wCMw4&export=download https[:]//www.dropbox.com/s/8zswaln4nm0neap/Action%20Plan%202022.zip?dl=1 http[:]//103.75.190.224/Enable_Adobe_Flash_Player.zip https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1xr-NUG2el_8wl6Lnvkp-q17rV3C_vxC&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1fMn9S7Vln8BsZBL-VcNdJF8SkKzwTRov&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=14topBrJNM5J1m4h2bO3ihi5M6apWnx8S&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1aTbT-p28UK-KaYttQT3nldynHnVdPS6w&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1roe1BE_Riy7AVbqtJZUxKTHkNvs3yn3a&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1g36jBkVLHubXsKrf9MaUkbRwBYv6lu7-&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1UHAuqp6a3qNZfzF51-p3XBDYmK6G77aYL&export=download https[:]//drive.google.com/uc?id=1zlvioLjo9HjTVqP0fDBrkQnJACW9HABf&export=download

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	c0b9438186e27a1ebba214724a35195ce1f3fea41b6c0b69a10c649688371ec3 72b870a6914798b75bd45e483a47bf1c6eabd185ea577b621a23242a13ec58df 186c3d32b3674faaf2c59b780ec2e5aeedc48199beae07c69e7cc14180c3683b 1ba12162a50fd5acbb38d9d0a99efb3b43358457e3279b86954dfff39b5cde4d d8f54575aff075268200250b3ed4af1da894db2199432b7110605003c6afba4a 492fd69150d0cb6765e5201c144e26783b785242f4cf807d3425f8b8df060062 6478cbb620e1a6fe1fb7e9e15b37fdc10668aa5bf2c825b8cd65b129e6443e60 f2b10278aaa2dfc4344119551f624679b5a3d2501b39ec989b87690e0d357f42 dcefa4f651108d8371806403da4be9675797940faa580cc64f83116517c55ca7 ef3966d15af3665ee5126df394cefd6f78fce77db7a70d5f35c19c234715035 2f2a8a001072f14c066bea15388af2155b02e0046180e450268db6bcdafa6e5a 262c6ad46bacd268900008d6cd32ea5bcfe032ffc0bf82e838e234cdca374d64 b2a86c5e1f0812483b0fdbde162457fd7ee71809a8a03c72762c037b1430115e 9ef78cdd09a9b6ddb095e2474d9b888f2d4854a1324c46ec1db368dde390fddc 064fe5bc15828693ac62cfd7e83f705d734e2554d2ff8ed82f701864512e7624 5d5c6d118ee90fe675a7d7bb8af9640bcc76caff9b2ehead4d06f74654f56260 536fa7a7bcc7ba39da329a1656a2ac0448a9f01885bf48de6f15f554ce7994ac 8912199477e11df4409f6400ceb7c0e4a91ce77679948372d7d81e07dec68942 229508972ad52e0ae1ff2d74fc70ebefd8b816e212ced849fbe6c1c2a1350ef6 447a62c7e29e2da85884b6e4aea80aca2cc5ba86694733ca397a2c8ba0f8e197 1ffee8c9aee944f72aa595c8feb7c745d0a509ca9542e26993076d2052474fc9 575bfffe2a79606bbd91b6bb67224c2efda4fe34b4ce284996cfbf14c1cc79e0e

TYPE	VALUE
IPV4	89[:]:38:225:151 103[:]:15:29:179 202[:]:53:148:24 103[:]:15:28:208 202[:]:58:105:38 98[:]:142:251:29 202[:]:53:148:26

References

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<https://attack.mitre.org/groups/G0129/>

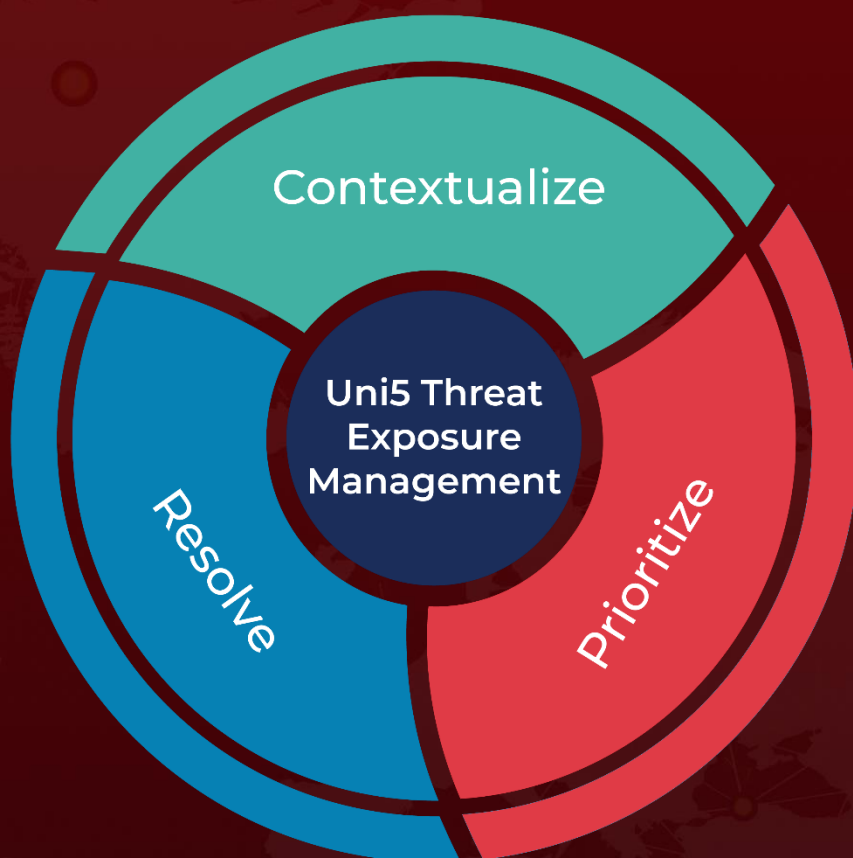
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What Next?

At **HivePro**, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with **Hive Pro Uni5**: Continuous Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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